



🔍 Search Help Center

[HOME](#) > [TIME & ATTENDANCE](#) > [TIME TRACKING POLICIES](#)

Overview of how policies are applied to time entries

This article is for:



ADMINISTRATORS



TIME & ATTENDANCE

In this article

Overview

How policies are assigned to time entries

Policy mismatches

Identify a policy mismatch

Resolve a policy mismatch

Frequently asked questions



Overview

When a worker tracks time in Rippling, each time entry is associated with a set of policies. These policies determine how the worker's hours are classified, including which overtime rules apply, which break rules are enforced, and which custom pay configurations apply.

There are four policy types that may be assigned to a time entry:

- **Time tracking policy:** Specifies the time tracking method the worker can use, workweek settings, and rounding rules.
- **Overtime policy:** Defines overtime classification rules and associated pay rates.
- **Break policy:** Specifies eligible break types, durations, and compliance rules.
- **Custom pay policy:** Configures custom pay rules such as shift differentials or holiday pay.

For these policies to apply to your workers, you must add them as policy members. While you can assign policies to individuals, it is strongly recommended that you set up policy assignment rules based on employee groupings using Rippling supergroups. This reduces manual work and ensures individuals are assigned to the correct policies as their employment with your company evolves.

A worker can only match one policy per type. If a worker matches membership to multiple policies of the same type, the first policy in the priority order is used.

How policies are assigned to time entries

Each time entry is associated with a set of policies that determine how time tracking, overtime, breaks, and custom pay are calculated.

When a policy is updated, Rippling automatically recalculates time entries that have not been approved or paid by payroll to reflect the new policy configuration.

When you create a new time entry - regardless of the pay period status, the time entry will always reference the policy configurations of the policy the worker is currently assigned to (if any).

Policy mismatches

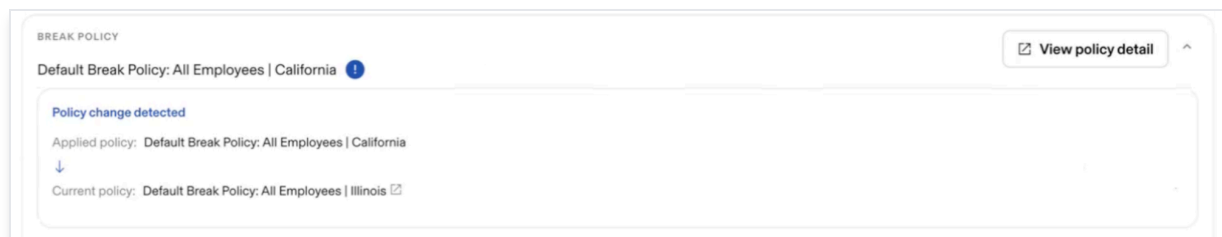
A policy mismatch occurs when a time entry's assigned policy differs from the policies currently assigned to the worker.

Note: The ability to view time entry policy mismatch notices is currently available to a limited set of customers. For more information, contact Rippling Support or your Account Manager.

There are four types of policy mismatches:

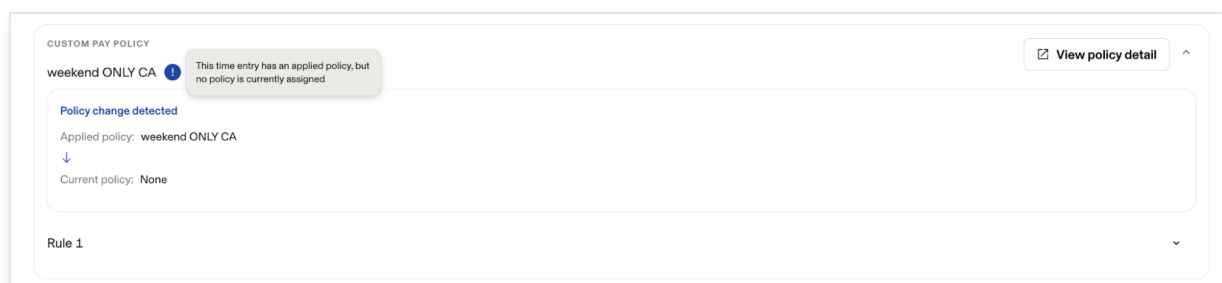
Policy changed

The worker was assigned to a different policy. This can happen due to a role transition, an update to their profile (such as a change in work location), or an update to the policy's membership rules or priority order.



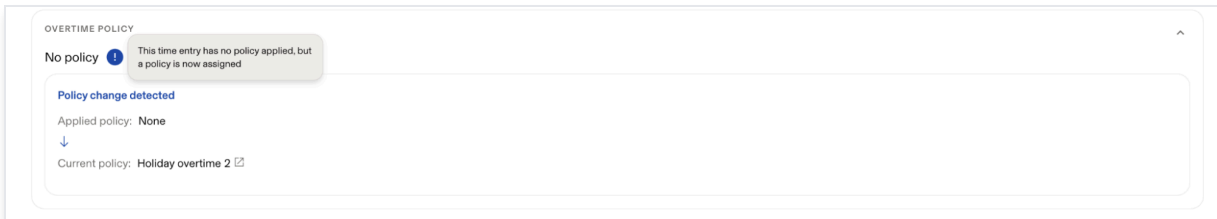
Policy removed

The worker no longer meets the criteria for any policy of that type. For example, they may have been removed from the supergroup that assigned them to the policy.



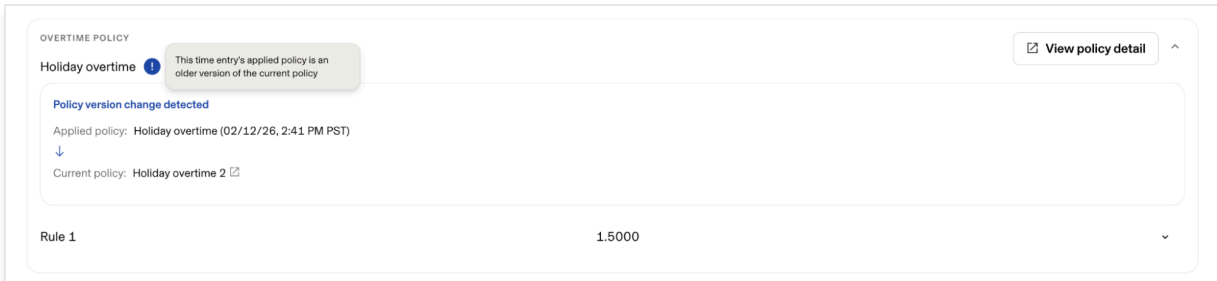
New policy added

The worker was not a member of a policy of that type, but they have since been assigned one.



Policy version mismatch

A previous version of the policy (for example, before payroll was finalized or paid) was applied, and the policy rules have since been updated. As a result, the entry reflects an earlier version of the policy.



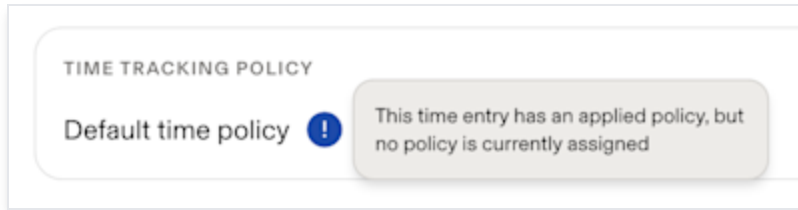
Identify a policy mismatch

When a time entry's policy does not match the worker's current active policy, Rippling displays a notice on the time entry. This helps you quickly understand how policy changes impact your time entries.

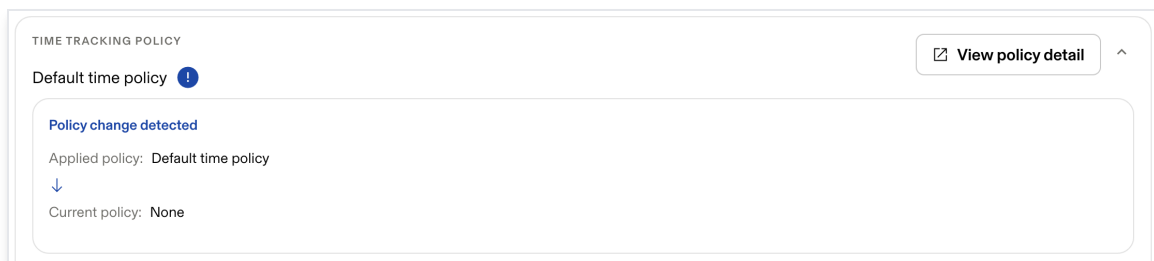
To view the policy details for a specific time entry, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. From the *Timecards* tab, click the worker's name.
4. Use the dropdown under the worker's name to select the appropriate pay period.

5. Click the **more** icon (three dots) associated with the time entry for which you want to view the policy details.
6. Select **View/edit time entry**.
7. Select the **Policies applied to this timecard** tab.
8. An alert icon identifies policy mismatches.
9. Hover over the **alert** icon to see a summary of the policy mismatch.



10. Click the **expand arrow** in the policy's box to view the details of the policy mismatch.



Resolve a policy mismatch

There are several ways to resolve a policy mismatch, depending on the current status of the time entry and what outcome you want.

Resolve a policy mismatch when the time entry has not been approved

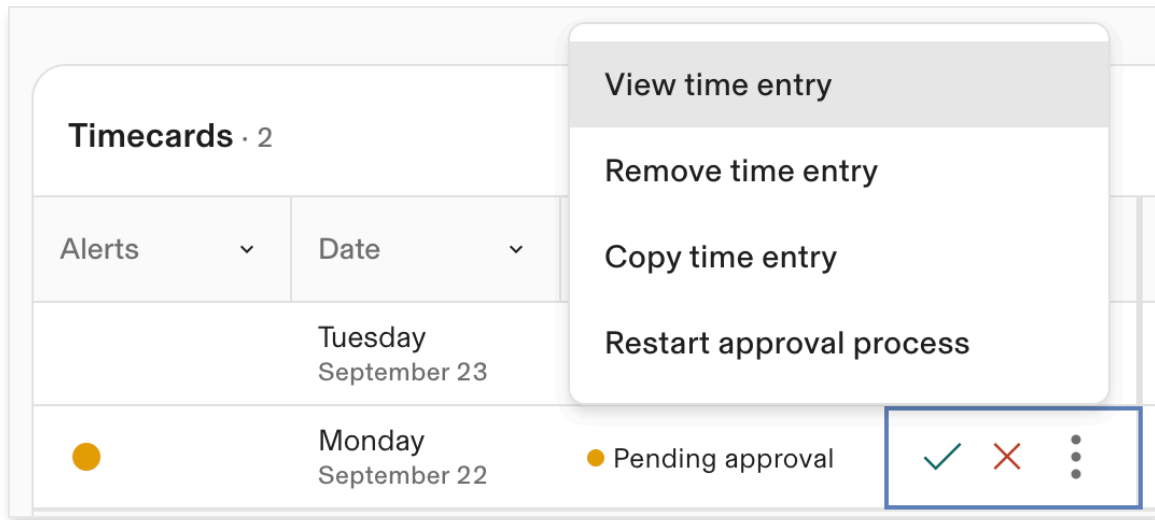
If the time entry has not been approved, you can change which policies are applied to it.

To edit an unapproved timecard, follow these steps:

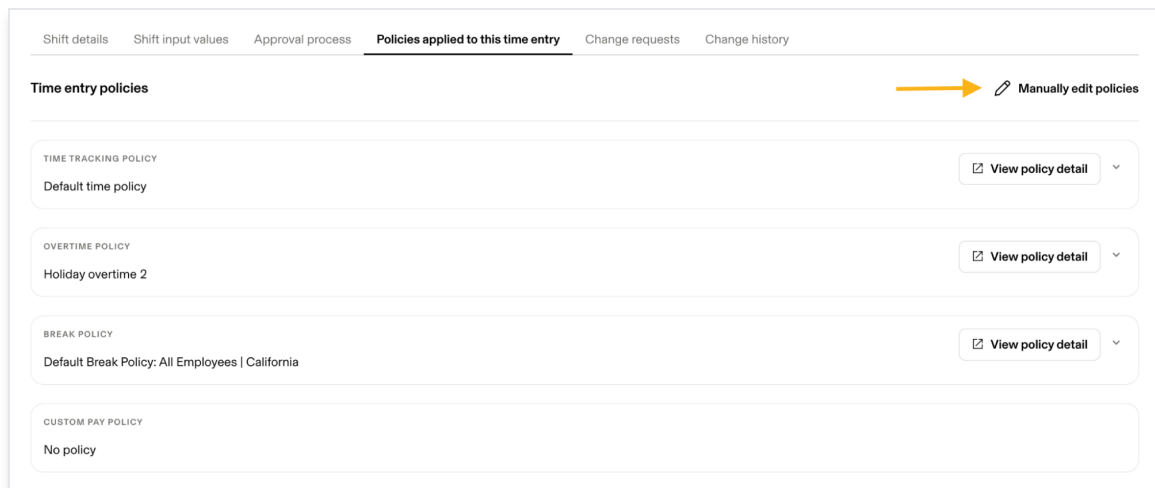
1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. Select the appropriate pay schedule.

Note: If employees are not assigned to a pay schedule in Payroll, they are displayed under the *No pay schedule* option in this drop down menu. Learn more in this article about [adding an employee to a pay schedule](#).

4. Find the employee for which you want to review or edit their timecard and click their name.
5. Find the time entry you want to edit and click the more icon (three dots) in its row.



6. Select **View time entry**.
7. Select the **Policies applied to this time entry** tab.
8. Click **Manually update policies**.



9. Select the appropriate policy for each policy type.

Shift details Shift input values Approval process **Policies applied to this time entry** Change requests Change history

Time entry policies

TIME TRACKING POLICY
Default time policy

OVERTIME POLICY
Holiday overtime 2

BREAK POLICY
Default Break Policy: All Employees | California

CUSTOM PAY POLICY
Select policy

10. Click **Submit**.

11. Click **Yes, I'm sure** to confirm you want to apply the new policies to this time entry.

12. Click **Done**.

The time entry will be recalculated based on the newly assigned policies. This includes recalculating overtime classifications, break compliance, and any custom pay rules.

Accept the mismatch

In many cases, the mismatch may be expected and correct. For example:

- A worker moved between states in the middle of a pay period. The time entries from before they moved correctly reflect the overtime policy for the state where the worker worked those shifts.
- A policy was intentionally changed, and the old time entries should keep the old policy's rules for historical accuracy.

If the policy associated with the time entry accurately reflects the rules that should have applied when the team member worked those hours, no action is needed.

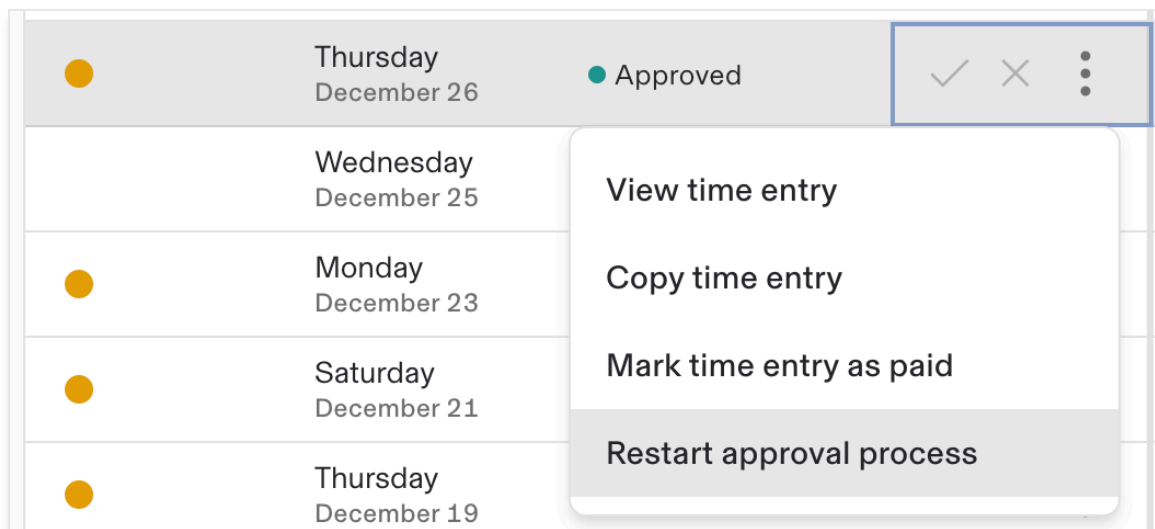
Resolve a policy mismatch when the time entry's payroll run has been approved, but not yet paid

If the time entry is part of a payroll run that has already been finalized, but not yet paid, the policies cannot be edited. To resolve the policy mismatch, you need to unapprove the payroll run and then edit the time entry.

Note: When you unapprove a payroll run, it affects all time entries in that run, not just the ones with policy mismatches. Coordinate with your payroll team before unapproving.

To resolve a policy mismatch when the time entry's payroll run has been approved, follow these steps:

1. Unapprove the payroll run that contains the time entry. Learn more in this article about [how to unapprove payroll](#). Once the payroll run is unapproved, the time entries within it become editable again.
2. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
3. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
4. From the *Timecards* tab, click the worker's name.
5. Use the dropdown under the worker's name to select the appropriate pay period.
6. Click the **more icon** (three dots) that corresponds to the time entry you want to edit.
7. Select **Restart approval process**.



8. Click **OK** to confirm you want to restart the approval process which will put the time entry back in a *Pending* approval state. Any required approvers will need to approve the time entry again.
9. Click the **more icon** (three dots) that corresponds to the time entry again.
10. Select **View time entry**.

11. Select the **Policies applied to this time entry** tab.
12. Click **Manually update policies**.
13. Select the appropriate policy for each policy type.
14. Click **Submit**.
15. Click **Yes, I'm sure** to confirm you want to apply the new policies to this time entry.
16. Click **Done**.
17. Approve the payroll run again. Learn more in this article about [how to run payroll](#).

The time entry will be recalculated based on the newly assigned policies. This includes recalculating overtime classifications, break compliance, and any custom pay rules.

Resolve a policy mismatch when the time entry has been paid

Time entries that have already been processed for payment cannot have their policies changed. If you need to make corrections to paid time entries, you may need to process adjustments in a subsequent payroll run. Learn more in this article about [correcting a payroll](#).

Frequently asked questions

Why do different days in the same pay period show different policies for the same worker?

This can happen when a worker's policy assignment changes mid-period due to profile changes or role transitions. For example, if a worker transferred from one location to another on Wednesday, time entries dated before the transfer use the old location's overtime policy, while entries dated after the transfer use the new location's overtime policy. This is expected behavior.

Will editing the policies on a time entry change the worker's pay?

Depending on what is edited, a worker's pay may be changed. When you edit the policies on a time entry, Rippling recalculates overtime, break compliance, and custom pay classifications based on the new policies. This can change the earnings associated with that time entry.

Will a manually edited time entry be affected by future policy changes?

No. Once you manually edit the policies on a time entry, that entry is locked to the policies you selected. Future changes to the employee's policy assignment will not overwrite your manual selection.

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